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Research Program/Project/Study Title: Pre-Service Teachers' Lived Experiences in Teaching English in Elementary Grades: Basis for Module Design

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Program or Project has a component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/Biological Sciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation	
Municipality/City: Dumarao	
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(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>	Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)
Research:	Development:						
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing						
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization						
(7) Sector/Commodity	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization (Education-ELT)						

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(9A) Abstract

In response to the evolving demands of English Language Teaching (ELT) in elementary education, this study explored the lived experiences of second-year BEEd pre-service teachers learning Spec 101 - Teaching English in Elementary Grades, to design effective ELT modules. Employing a qualitative-phenomenological approach focused on Husserlian investigation, seven informants were selected based on their successful completion of the course and their experiences of difficulty, participating voluntarily. In-depth interviews, guided by a researcher-developed questionnaire, were conducted to uncover their perspectives.

Colaizzi's data analysis strategy was utilized to derive themes from the interviews, revealing five major insights: (1) Speaking anxiety attack is real, (2) Demonstration teaching is such a big effort, (3) Lesson planning is overwhelming, (4) Teamwork is the best and (5) Instructional materials are of great help. These findings underscored the significance of incorporating student voices into curriculum development to create relevant and engaging teaching modules.

As a result of the study, a self-instructional English Language module was developed to address students' learning needs, particularly focusing on the lack of adequate instructional materials for Spec 101. The research highlighted that providing comprehensive instructional resources and designing interactive activities are crucial for enhancing the English language teaching and learning process.

(9B) Keywords: *ELT module, lesson plan, demonstration teaching, speaking anxiety*

(10) Introduction

The study focused on the Bachelor of Elementary Education (BEEd) program and its initiative to prepare teachers who effectively contribute to national educational goals and societal transformation. The introduction of the new curriculum by the Commission on Higher Education in 2018 necessitated adjustments, particularly in courses like Spec 101 - Teaching English in Elementary Grades, which was unexpectedly offered to first-year students. This course focused on enhancing language proficiency and practical teaching skills, including lesson planning and demonstration teaching, which presented challenges for freshman students. Observations from the researcher, who also facilitated Spec 101, highlighted students' struggles in various tasks, including lesson planning and public speaking. Furthermore, the study advocated for continuous enhancement of teacher education programs to meet evolving educational demands. It emphasized collaboration among faculty, sustained professional development, and the creation of relevant instructional materials to ensure high-quality English language instruction in teacher education institutions. The researcher aimed to address these challenges by exploring pre-service teachers' experiences in Spec 101 to develop targeted interventions, such as tailored instructional modules, to better support their learning needs in English language teaching.

(11) Methods or Methodology

This study employed a qualitative-phenomenological research design, specifically utilizing the Husserlian phenomenological method to explore the lived experiences of seven BEEd pre-service teachers who met the following inclusion criteria: a previous BEEd student who took and passed Spec 101 -Teaching English in Elementary Grades last school year 2022-2023, had experienced difficulty in the said subject and voluntarily participated. The stated criteria served as the main basis for getting the informants of the study and the number of informants was based on saturation point. In-depth interviews were the primary data collection method, guided by a validated interview guide developed with input from experts in English language teaching.

Data collection adhered to ethical standards, including obtaining clearance from the Ethics Research Committee and securing informed consent from participants. Interviews were conducted face-to-face, tape-recorded, and transcribed for analysis. The researcher as the main instrument ensured the integrity and depth of data collection and analysis, contributing to a comprehensive understanding of the pre-service teachers' lived experiences in the context of their English language teaching preparation.

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Data analysis followed Colaizzi's method for phenomenological research, involving steps as presented below, to extract, organize, and analyze themes from the interview transcripts.

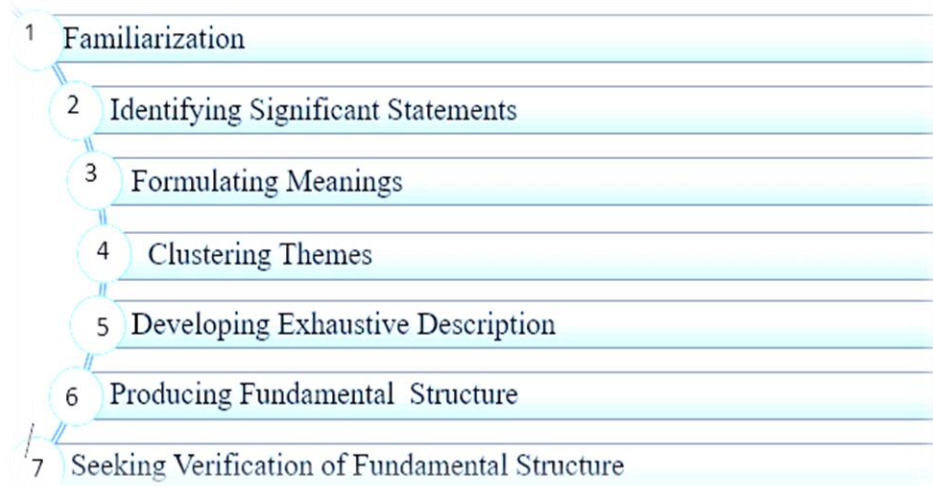


Table 2

Examples of Significant Statements

Significant Statements	Transcript No.	Line No.
...and speaking in front of the class, even though you assign us reporting I still feel nervous. Then you scold us if you act like kids in front like swaying of the hands when speaking. Every time I do my reporting, I feel nervous, ma'am. (P3)	7	151-153
The first demonstration was our first ever experience, so we can say that our first time wasn't that perfect. Demonstration has been difficult to us, because it's nerve wracking since it's the first time. (P4)	5	91-92
The making of the lesson plan, obviously, we struggled a lot in that area. Though, you have discussed to us the example of lesson plan and how to make each of them (P6)	3	81-82
Teamwork helped us a lot. Even though we were new as classmates we helped each other in making our reports, assignments, visual aids, power points and others. (P1)	4	140-141
There should be a guide in making lesson plan especially to a first timer like us. There should be a guide for students in making it. I also recommend to have a book, Ma'am. (P1)	9	159-160

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Table 3

Sample of Formulated meanings extracted from significant statements

Significant Statements	Formulated Meaning
...and speaking in front of the class, even though you assign us reporting I still feel nervous. Then you scold us if you act like kids in front like swaying of the hands when speaking. Every time I do my reporting, I feel nervous, ma'am. (P3)	Informants feel very anxious or afraid when they are asked to speak.
The first demonstration was our first ever experience, so we can say that our first time wasn't that perfect. Demonstration has been difficult to us, because it's nerve wracking since it's the first time. (P4, lines 91-92)	They struggled with demonstration teaching, finding it to be challenging or hard to do.
The making of the lesson plan, obviously, we struggled a lot on that area. Though, you have discussed to us the example of lesson plan and how to make each of them (P6)	They met difficulties in making lesson plans.
... Teamwork helped us a lot. Even though we were new as classmates we helped each other in making our reports, assignments, visual aids, power points and others. (P1)	Through teamwork and collaboration heavy tasks become lighter and easier.
There should be a guide in making lesson plan especially to a first timer like us. There should be a guide for students in making it. I also recommend to have a book, Ma'am. (P1)	Informants need instructional materials in the subject, like books and guides in lesson planning, and other references are evident.

Table 4

Sample of Theme, Speaking anxiety attack is real, and its construction process from clusters of themes and formulated meanings

Formulated Meaning	Sub-Theme	Emergent Themes
Speaking particularly in front of people is very difficult for the informants They got nervous about reciting in English Every time they do speaking tasks, nervousness attacks them. They forgot what to say in English because of nervousness.	Experiencing anxiety in speaking	Speaking anxiety attack is real.

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Table 5

Summary of sub-themes and emergent themes

Formulated Meaning	Sub-Theme	Emergent Themes
They feel very anxious or afraid when they are asked to speak.	Experiencing anxiety in speaking	Speaking anxiety attack is real.
They struggled with demonstration teaching, finding it to be challenging or hard to do.	Encountered difficulty in demonstration teaching	Demonstration teaching is such a big effort.
They met difficulties in making lesson plans.	Challenges in lesson plan preparation	Lesson planning is overwhelming.
Through teamwork and collaboration heavy tasks become lighter and easier.	The power of collaboration	Teamwork is the best.
Their need for instructional materials in the subject, like books, and guides in lesson planning and other references are evident.	Valuing of instructional materials in teaching and Learning	Instructional materials are of great help.

(12) Results and Discussions

Profile of the Informants

Informant	Age	Sex	Marital Status	Children	Track/Curriculum
A	22	Female	Live in	None	K to 12 (Technical-Vocational-Livelihood track)
B	21	Female	Single	None	K to 12 (Accountancy, Business, and Management strand)
C	24	Female	Married	1 child	Old Curriculum
D	21	Female	Single	None	K to 12 (Technical-Vocational-Livelihood track)
E	23	Female	Live in	1 child	Old Curriculum
F	23	Female	Single	None	Old Curriculum
G	21	Female	Live in	1 child	K to 12 (Technical-Vocational-Livelihood track)

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Five significant themes emerged from the study and analysis of informants' lived experiences in learning Spec 101 - Teaching English in Elementary Grades. These themes were then expounded with supporting significant statements from the data, related studies, and findings from research in the field of English language teaching.

Theme 1: Speaking anxiety attack is real. The interviews with informants revealed significant experiences of speaking anxiety during various activities such as recitation, oral presentations, and classroom discussions. They described feelings of apprehension, fear, and tension, particularly when addressing audiences or classmates. The anxiety often stemmed from difficulties in expressing themselves in English and fears of making mistakes or being evaluated negatively. These claims are supported by the following responses:

"Aahhmm... Of the four macro skills, ma'am I found difficult in speaking English. I'm ashamed to speak because I might do it wrongly. Speaking is very challenging in my part. It seemed so hard to speak especially in front of many people. "(P1, lines 69-71)

"Reciting in English, because I feel nervous, ma'am." (P4, line 51)

The studies by MacIntyre and Gardner (1991) and Liu (2017) provide a comprehensive understanding of how foreign language anxiety (FLA) specifically impacts non-native English speakers. MacIntyre and Gardner highlight that FLA is intensified by fears of making mistakes and being judged, which can significantly impair a learner's willingness and confidence to speak English. This anxiety is rooted in both the fear of language errors and perceived negative evaluations from others. Complementing this, Liu's research reveals a direct correlation between English proficiency levels and speaking anxiety, showing that individuals with lower English proficiency experience heightened anxiety. Their lack of confidence in their language skills intensifies fears of making errors and performing poorly, leading to more frequent anxiety attacks during English communication.

Theme 2: Demonstration teaching is such a big effort. The theme explored how informants perceived demonstration teaching within their educational experiences as pre-service teachers. They viewed demonstration teaching as a demanding yet crucial method for training future teachers. It required significant time and effort to succeed, serving as a bridge between theoretical knowledge and practical teaching skills. Sample informants' feelings and utterances about demonstration teaching:

"In... (pause) In the demonstration, also, it was hard because it's the first time we did it in English. We were shocked, ma'am, that we have that. And we also have that in other specs, as well." (P2, lines 107-108)

"The first demonstration was our first ever experience, so we can say that our first time wasn't that perfect. Demonstration has been difficult for us because it's nerve-wracking since it's the first time." (P4, lines 91-92)

This theme aligns with the findings of Beauchamp and Thomas (2019) in their study, "Bridging the Gap Between Theory and Practice: Pre-Service Teachers' Experiences of Demonstration Teaching," which highlights the difficulties pre-service teachers encounter when attempting to apply theoretical knowledge in practical teaching scenarios. The study emphasizes the challenges of translating pedagogical theories into effective teaching practices during demonstrations. Similarly, Korthagen and Wubbels (2015) in their study, "Challenges and Strategies in Teaching Demonstrations: A Study of Pre-Service Teachers," further stress these issues by examining specific difficulties faced during teaching demonstrations. Their research identifies key challenges such as classroom management and lesson planning, and suggests strategies for overcoming these hurdles.

Theme 3, Lesson planning is overwhelming. The third theme that emerged from informants' interviews regarding their significant learning experiences in Spec 101 - Teaching English in Elementary Grades was the overwhelming nature of lesson planning. This theme reflects the challenges informants faced in creating effective lesson plans, which are essential for guiding teachers in delivering structured learning experiences that meet students' educational needs. The following were samples of their sentiments and struggles in lesson-planning activities:

"Then, the making of the lesson plan. At first, I find it hard because I don't have an idea to construct the objectives, it was our first time. "(P6, lines)

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"That lesson planning and demonstration teaching, ma'am. I have lots of mistakes in doing it. So, I need to know more about making lesson plans. Yours was just a starter. But we are thankful we learned something. "(P1, 86-90)

The challenges pre-service teachers face with lesson planning are affirmed by several studies. Lee and Hargrove (2017) in their study, "The Challenges of Lesson Planning in Teacher Preparation Programs," identify common difficulties such as aligning lessons with curriculum standards, managing time effectively, and integrating diverse instructional strategies. They suggest that these issues often arise from insufficient practice and limited feedback during teacher preparation. Similarly, Anderson and Thomas (2014), in their study "The Gap Between Theory and Practice in Lesson Planning: Insights from Pre-Service Teachers," highlight the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application. Their research reveals that pre-service teachers frequently struggle to apply theoretical concepts in real classroom settings, resulting in lesson plans that are challenging to implement effectively and align with educational standards. Hence, a need for more practice and constructive feedback to bridge the gap between theory and practice in lesson planning is important.

Theme 4: Teamwork is the best. The informants' positive experience with teamwork in their Spec 101 - Teaching English in Elementary Grades class resonates with research emphasizing the importance of collaboration in educational settings. These concepts of teamwork are demonstrated in the subsequent statements:

"Ahmm... You made use of cooperative learning for us, ma'am. We always worked in pairs or groups, that's why we developed teamwork and bonding. Helping each other." (P4, lines 98-101)

".... the best experience was when we had a team working." (P2, line 116)

Studies by Suwarjo & Imania (2015), Luca & Tarricone (2002), and Scarnati (2001) highlight teamwork as essential for achieving educational goals through shared efforts, effective communication, and mutual support among peers. These findings underscore that teamwork not only enhances learning outcomes by facilitating cooperative problem-solving and knowledge sharing but also fosters a sense of unity, camaraderie, and friendship among students. In the context of teacher education, teamwork in Spec 101 enabled informants to pool their ideas, knowledge, and resources to tackle challenging tasks collectively, demonstrating the practical benefits of collaborative learning experiences in preparing future educators.

The last theme was **"Instructional materials are of great help"**. This theme emerged from the informants' experiences in learning Spec 101 - Teaching English in Elementary Grades, focusing on the critical role of learning resources in their educational journey. Due to the subject's novelty and limited availability of materials, informants expressed a strong need for resources that could support their learning needs effectively. These were shown in the following utterances:

"Ah, the materials, books and other instructional materials that are accessible anytime, ma'am. Those that are within our reach, so we won't have to look anymore." (P4, lines 110-111)

"I would recommend, ma'am, that there should be instructional materials. The major problems for me, ma'am, are the instructional materials and references." (P2, lines 120-121)

"Ahhmm... (Pause)... There should be books as guides so we won't have to rely on the Internet. If there's a book, then you'll have a guide." (P3, lines 245-246)

This aligns with findings by Shavelson et al. (cited in Samaranayake, 2017), emphasizing how instructional materials influence teachers' classroom practices and lesson planning. Ajoke's study (2017) further supports this notion by demonstrating the positive impact of visual instructional aids on student academic performance, indicating that such aids enhance memory retention and skill acquisition. Similarly, Esu, Erukoha, and Umoren (2004 as cited in Ajoke, 2017) underscore the importance of teaching aids in promoting effective instructional delivery and improving learning outcomes in educational settings. Together, these studies underscore the pivotal

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role of well-designed instructional materials in supporting both teachers and students in achieving educational objectives effectively.

Based on the study's findings, a self-instructional module was specifically developed for English language teaching in Spec 101 - Teaching English in Elementary Grades. This module targets the identified needs of future teachers by enhancing their proficiency across the four macro skills of language teaching, facilitating the creation of effective learning plans, and guiding the development of appropriate teaching materials. The creation of the self-instruction module in Teaching English in the Elementary Grades: Guide for Teachers, directly addresses the challenges and experiences reported by informants during interviews. These themes include (1) Speaking anxiety attack is real, (2) Demonstration teaching is such a big effort, (3) Lesson planning is overwhelming, (4) Teamwork is the best and (5) Instructional materials are of great help. Integrating these themes into the module aims to comprehensively support and prepare pre-service teachers for their roles in teaching English.

(13) Conclusions

1. After studying and analyzing the lived experiences of informants in learning Spec 101 - Teaching English in the Elementary Grades, five significant themes emerged. These themes encapsulated the varied experiences and challenges faced by informants in their journey through Spec 101, highlighting key aspects of their learning and professional development as future teachers:

Speaking Anxiety. Informants reported experiencing anxiety, fear, and tension during speaking activities, such as presentations and recitations.

Demonstration Teaching Challenges. Informants found demonstration teaching to be demanding, requiring significant effort to succeed.

Overwhelming Lesson Planning. Informants struggled with the complexity and workload of lesson planning, especially as newcomers to the process.

Positive Impact of Teamwork. Collaborative efforts among classmates were highlighted as fostering unity, camaraderie, and effective task completion.

Value of Instructional Materials. Informants emphasized the importance of instructional materials in supporting their learning and teaching effectiveness in the classroom.

2. The development of the Self-Instruction Module in Teaching Elementary Grades: Guide for Teachers represents a targeted response to the challenges and needs identified among future teachers in Spec 101. By addressing areas such as language teaching skills, lesson planning, and instructional material development, the module aims to enhance the preparation and effectiveness of pre-service teachers in delivering English language instruction. This initiative underscores the importance of tailored educational resources in supporting teacher education programs and preparing educators for successful classroom practices.

(13) Recommendations

1. The BEED program, under the guidance of its dean and faculty, may initiate a curriculum that addresses speaking anxiety among students. This initiative may emphasize the development of appropriate language content and speaking skills, integrating technology and social media platforms to enhance cultural awareness and global experiences.

2. The teacher education department, specifically the BEED program, may offer comprehensive training in demonstration teaching to equip future teachers with practical teaching skills, emphasizing the importance of demonstrating effective teaching behaviors and gaining valuable classroom experience.

3. The teacher education department, particularly the BEED program, may provide structured guidance and training in lesson planning to assist future teachers in mastering this critical aspect of teaching, ensuring they develop skills in organizing lessons, selecting appropriate activities, and aligning instructional goals with curriculum objectives.

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4. The teacher education department may foster a collaborative learning environment that encourages teamwork among students and may implement activities and projects that require teamwork to enhance cooperative skills and achieve shared educational goals.

5. The department through its dean or program chair, and faculty may emphasize the importance of instructional materials in enhancing teaching effectiveness. Training in the development and use of various teaching aids, such as visual aids and technology-based tools, to support diverse learning styles and facilitate meaningful learning experiences may also be provided.

(14) Output

- Self-Instructional Module in English Language Teaching

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted

(16) Beneficiaries

- Students and faculty/course facilitators

(17) Economic Analysis

(17) Acknowledgments

(18) References

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